

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250287479

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

CHAO; Hsien-Wen et al.

MICROWAVE HEAT PROCESSING APPARATUS

Abstract

A microwave heat processing apparatus is provided. The microwave heat processing apparatus includes a microwave chamber and a microwave source. The microwave chamber is configured to heat up a thread type object and includes a primary waveguide tube and a microwave absorber. The primary waveguide tube is configured to accommodate the thread type object, in which a tube wall of the primary waveguide tube has an auxiliary opening and a center extension direction does not pass through the auxiliary opening. The microwave absorber is in the primary waveguide tube. The microwave source connects to the primary waveguide tube.

Inventors: CHAO; Hsien-Wen (Hsinchu, TW), HSU; Hung-Chun (Hsinchu, TW), CHEN; Yan-Cheng (Hsinchu, TW), CHANG; Tsun-Hsu (Hsinchu, TW), LIN; Sheng-Shiun (Kaohsiung City, TW), HUNG; Chia-Chi (Kaohsiung City, TW), CHUNG; Ching-Cheng (Kaohsiung City, TW), HWANG; Long-Tyan (Kaohsiung City, TW), GUAN; Shih-Hau (Kaohsiung City, TW)

Applicant: FORMOSA PLASTICS CORPORATION (Kaohsiung City, TW)

Family ID: 1000007871413

Appl. No.: 18/663848

Filed: May 14, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

TW

113202188

Mar. 05, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H05B6/70 (20060101); H05B6/80 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] This application claims priority to Taiwan Application Serial Number 113202188, filed Mar. 5, 2024, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

Field of Invention

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a microwave heat processing apparatus. In particular, the present disclosure relates to a microwave heat processing apparatus including a microwave absorber.

Description of Related Art

[0003] Currently, existed apparatus can perform heat processing on the thread-type objects by using a method of a standing wave or a traveling wave. The method of the standing wave has a smaller and more concentrated heating range and is unable to uniformly heat the thread-type objects. The method of the traveling wave has a larger heating range but the final temperatures of the thread-type objects may be different due to the different microwave-absorption rates of the thread-type objects.

SUMMARY

[0004] According to some embodiments of the present disclosure, a microwave heat processing apparatus is provided. A particular arrangement structure of the microwave absorber is disposed in the microwave heat processing apparatus. The arrangement structure of the microwave absorber has a high temperature stability and extraordinary thermal conductivity. The thread-type object may be heated by absorbing the traveling wave produced by a microwave source and further heated by the microwave absorber. Thus, the present disclosure may achieve a uniform heating during the microwave-heat processing thereby accomplishing a high efficiency, stable and uniform heat processing.

[0005] According to some embodiments of the present disclosure, a microwave heat processing apparatus is provided. The microwave heat processing apparatus includes a microwave chamber and a microwave source. The microwave chamber is configured to heat the thread-type object and includes a primary waveguide tube and a microwave absorber. The primary waveguide tube is configured to accommodate the thread-type object, in which a tube wall of the primary waveguide tube has an auxiliary opening and the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube does not pass through the auxiliary opening. The microwave absorber is in the primary waveguide tube. The microwave source is connected to the primary waveguide tube.

[0006] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which the primary waveguide tube further includes a first opening and a second opening and the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube passes through the first opening and the second opening.

[0007] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which a plane where the auxiliary opening is located intersects a plane where the first opening is located.

[0008] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which the tube wall of the primary waveguide tube further has a cooling opening, and a size of the auxiliary opening is greater than a size of the cooling opening.

[0009] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which the primary waveguide tube has a first portion and a second

portion, and the first portion of the primary waveguide tube is closer to the microwave source than the second portion of the primary waveguide tube, and the cooling opening is disposed at the first portion of the primary waveguide tube.

[0010] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which a plurality of auxiliary openings are symmetrically disposed with respect to the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube.

[0011] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which an extending direction of the auxiliary openings is parallel with the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube.

[0012] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above further includes a microwave baffle that covers the auxiliary openings.

[0013] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which the microwave chamber further comprises an auxiliary waveguide tube connected between the primary waveguide tube and the microwave source, wherein the microwave source deviates from the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube.

[0014] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which the auxiliary waveguide tube has a discharge opening, and the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube passes through the discharge opening.

[0015] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which a size of the auxiliary opening is greater than a size of the microwave absorber.

[0016] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which a length of the auxiliary opening is greater than a length of the microwave absorber.

[0017] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which the microwave absorber forms a heating chamber inside the primary waveguide tube.

[0018] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the microwave heat processing apparatus is described above, in which the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube passes through the heating chamber.

[0019] According to some embodiments of the present disclosure, a microwave heat processing apparatus is provided. The microwave heat processing apparatus includes a microwave chamber and a microwave source. The microwave chamber is configured to heat a thread-type object and includes a primary waveguide tube, a first auxiliary opening and a second auxiliary opening. The primary waveguide tube is configured to accommodate the thread-type object. The first auxiliary opening is on a first tube wall of the primary waveguide tube. The second auxiliary opening is on a second tube wall of the primary waveguide tube opposite to the first tube wall, in which a center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube does not pass through the first and second auxiliary openings. The microwave absorber is in the primary waveguide tube. The microwave source is connected to the primary waveguide tube.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0020] FIG. 1 is a top view of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 2A is a stereoscopic schematic view of the microwave chamber of the microwave heat

processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0022] FIG. 2B is a top view of the microwave chamber of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0023] FIG. 2C is a side view of the microwave chamber of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0024] FIG. 3A is a stereoscopic schematic view of the primary waveguide tube of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. 3B is a stereoscopic schematic view of the primary waveguide tube of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0026] FIG. 3C is a stereoscopic schematic view of the primary waveguide tube of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0027] FIG. 3D is a stereoscopic schematic view of the primary waveguide tube of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0028] FIG. 4 is a stereoscopic schematic view of the microwave heat processing apparatus installed on a driving device, which uses the arrangements of the microwave absorber to achieve the heat processing in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0029] Reference will now be made in detail to the present embodiments of the disclosure.

However, it should be understood that the embodiments of the disclosure provide many practicable concepts for implementing in various subject matters. The embodiments discussed and disclosed herein are for the illustration only, and are not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure. The term “first” and “second” used herein do not indicate specific order or sequence, but are only used to distinguish the units or operations described in same technical terms.

[0030] FIG. 1 is a top view of the microwave heat processing apparatus **100** in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the microwave heat processing apparatus includes a microwave chamber **101** and a microwave source **106**. The microwave chamber **101** includes a primary waveguide tube **102** and an auxiliary waveguide tube **104**.

[0031] As shown in FIG. 1, in the present embodiment, the primary waveguide tube **102** is configured to accommodate a thread-type object **400** (please refer to the following FIG. 4). The primary waveguide tube **102** further includes a first opening **102A** and a second opening **102B**. A center extending direction **S1** of the primary waveguide tube **102** passes through the first opening **102A** and the second opening **102B**, and a plane where the first opening **102A** is located is substantially in parallel with a plane where the second opening **102B** is located. The tube wall **102H** of the primary waveguide tube **102** has at least one auxiliary opening **102C** and the center extending direction **S1** of the primary waveguide tube **102** does not pass through the auxiliary opening **102C**. These auxiliary openings **102C** are symmetrically disposed along the center extending direction **S1** of the primary waveguide tube **102** and the extending direction of the auxiliary openings **102C** is parallel with the center extending direction **S1** of the primary waveguide tube **102**. In other embodiments, the auxiliary openings **102C** may be disposed unsymmetrically. The plane where the auxiliary opening **102C** is located may intersect the plane where the first opening **102A** is located and the plane where the second opening **102B** is located, for example, perpendicularly.

[0032] In the present embodiment, the primary waveguide tube **102** further includes functional openings **102D**. The functional openings **102D** may be adjusted to the different functional openings according to different process requirements. For example, in some embodiments, multiple functional openings **102D** may be disposed on the primary waveguide tube **102**, in which the functional openings **102D** may serve as observation windows of the primary waveguide tube **102**. The functional openings **102D** may monitor a temperature of a microwave absorber **200** (please refer to the following FIG. 2A to 2C) during the microwave process. This design may adjust the

microwave temperature in real time to heat the thread-type object **400** evenly. For example, in another embodiment, the functional openings **102D** may serve as the gas filling openings. The functional openings **102D** may be filled with gases of different temperatures according to the process requirements to facilitate different processing process for the thread-type object **400**. The number and the opening positions of the functional openings **102D** may be adjusted according to the functional or process requirements, but the opening size of the functional opening **102D** have to be below a certain size to prevent the microwave from leaking. It should be noticed that these examples should not limit the scope of the present embodiment.

[0033] In addition, in some embodiments, the tube wall **102H** of the primary waveguide tube **102** has a cooling opening **102E**, and the size of the auxiliary opening **102C** is larger than the size of the cooling opening **102E**. The cooling opening **102E** may allow air to enter or to be exhausted to facilitate the control of the temperature of the primary waveguide tube **102**. The number and the opening position of the cooling opening **102E** may be adjusted according to the functional or process requirements, but the size of the cooling opening **102E** have to be below a certain size to prevent the microwave from leaking. It should be noticed that these examples should not limit the scope of the embodiment.

[0034] Referring back to FIG. 1, in the present embodiment, the primary waveguide tube **102** has a first portion **102F** and a second portion **102G**, and the first portion **102F** of the primary waveguide tube **102** is closer to the microwave source **106** than the second portion **102G** of the primary waveguide tube **102**, in which the cooling opening **102E** is disposed on the first portion **102F** of the primary waveguide tube **102**. In some embodiments, the temperature of the first portion **102F** is between the microwave source **106** and the second portion **102G**. In other words, the temperature of the first portion **102F** may be higher than the temperature of the second portion **102G**, so that the thread-type object **400** may be first heated at a low temperature and then be heated at a high temperature. The temperatures of the first portion **102F** and the second portion **102G** may be adjusted according to the functional and process requirements. For example, in some embodiments, according to the process requirements, the thread-type object **400** need to be first heated at a high temperature and then further be heated at a low temperature. Thus, the temperature of the first portion **102F** may be adjusted to be higher than the temperature of the second portion **102G**. The control of the temperature section may be accomplished by the cooling opening **102E** or other shape configurations.

[0035] In the present embodiment, the microwave chamber **101** further includes an auxiliary waveguide tube **104**, in which the auxiliary waveguide tube **104** has a discharge opening **104B**. The auxiliary waveguide tube **104** is connected between the primary waveguide tube **102** and the microwave source **106** with a curve angle **A1**, in which the microwave source **106** deviates from the center extending direction **S1** of the primary waveguide tube **102**. The curve angle **A1** may be adjusted according to the functional or process requirements. For example, in the present embodiment, the curve angle **A1** is 90 degree to facilitate the center extending direction **S1** of the primary waveguide tube **102** passing the discharge opening **104B**. Thus, the discharge opening **104B** may be coaxial (e.g., substantially parallel) with the first opening **102A** and the second opening **102B**. This design may decrease the bending number of the thread-type object **400**, thereby keeping the thread-type object **400** substantially horizontal and achieving a uniform heating performance. It should be noticed that these examples should not limit the scope of the embodiment.

[0036] The microwave source **106** is coupled to the primary waveguide tube **102** through the auxiliary waveguide tube **104**. The microwave source **106** is configured to generate the quasi-traveling wave, and to transmit the quasi-traveling to the primary waveguide tube **102** by the auxiliary waveguide tube **104**, thus heating the thread-type object **400** (please refer to the following FIG. 4) in the primary waveguide tube **102**. In some embodiments, the primary waveguide tube **102** and the auxiliary waveguide tube **104** include wave-non-absorbing metallic materials, e.g.,

aluminum. This design may limit the microwave inside the primary waveguide tube **102** and the auxiliary waveguide tube **104** to increase the heating efficiency.

[0037] FIG. 2A is a stereoscopic schematic view of the microwave chamber **101** of the microwave heat processing apparatus in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. FIG. 2B is the top view of FIG. 2A. FIG. 2C is the side view of FIG. 2A. Please refer to FIG. 1, FIG. 2A, FIG. 2B, and FIG. 2C. In some embodiments, the microwave absorber **200** is in the primary waveguide tube **102** and configured to absorb the quasi-traveling wave. The microwave absorber includes a lossy material with a loss tangent greater than 0.01. The lossy material may be a high temperature resistant and wave-absorbing material which may transfer the loss of the electrical magnetic wave in the medium into thermal energy, such as silicon carbide (SiC), silicon nitride (Si₃N₄), the compounds of SiC and Si₃N₄, other suitable material, or the combination thereof.

[0038] In the present embodiment, the microwave absorber **200** is substantially parallelly disposed in the primary waveguide tube **102**. A space may be formed between the microwave absorbers **200** to pass the thread-type object **400**, thereby further heating the thread-type object **400**. It should be noticed that these examples should not limit the scope of the embodiment. The number, shapes and arrangements of the microwave absorber **200** may be adjusted according to the functional and process requirements.

[0039] In some embodiments, the microwave absorber **200** may be disposed in the first portion **102F** and the second portion **102G** of the primary waveguide tube **102** by the auxiliary opening **102C**. The microwave chamber **101** further includes a removable microwave baffle **103** which is configured to cover the auxiliary opening **102C**. The microwave baffle **103** may prevent the microwave from leaking and make the microwave absorber **200** easy to replace. This design increases the convenience and the variation of the microwave process.

[0040] As shown in FIG. 1, in some embodiments, the microwave source **106** further includes a power source **106A**, a protection device **106B**, a microwave generator **106C** and a controller **106D**.

[0041] In some embodiments, the power source **106A** is configured to provide the energy required by the microwave source **106**. The microwave generator **106C** is electrically connected to the power source **106A** and configured to generate the microwave required by the heat process. The type of the microwave generated by the microwave generator **106C** may be adjusted according to functional and process requirements. For example, in the present embodiment, the microwave generator generates the quasi-traveling wave with 2.45 GHz according to the structure of the microwave chamber **101**. The quasi-traveling wave may not create hot spots inside the microwave chamber **101**, such that the thread-type object **400** can be heated evenly. It should be noticed that these examples should not limit the scope of the embodiment.

[0042] In some embodiments, the protection device **106B** is connected to the microwave generator **106C**. For example, in some embodiments, the protection device **106B** connects the cool water device **500C** (please refer to following FIG. 4) and may guide the reflected microwave, that may damage the microwave generator **106C**, into cool water device **500C**. In addition, the cool water device **500C** may keep the microwave generator **106C** at certain working temperature. It should be noticed that these examples should not limit the scope of the embodiment.

[0043] In some embodiments, the controller **106D** is connected to the protection device **106B** and is configured to adjust the quasi-traveling wave. The control **106D** may control the loss of the quasi-traveling wave inside the microwave chamber. For example, in some embodiments, the controller **106D** may be an impedance matching device and adjust the feature of the quasi-traveling by the depth of the knobs of the controller **106D**, e.g., power, to optimize the heat efficiency of the quasi-traveling.

[0044] FIG. 3A to FIG. 3D is a stereoscopic schematic view of the primary waveguide tube **102** of the microwave heat processing apparatus **100** in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. Please refer to FIG. 3A to FIG. 3D. The shapes of the primary waveguide tube **102** may

be adjusted according to the functional and process requirements. For example, in some embodiments, the shapes of the primary waveguide tube **102** may be circle, square, rectangle and ellipse or any shapes that the thread-type object **400** may pass through. The number and shapes of the openings of the primary waveguide tube **102** may be adjusted according to the functional and the process requirements. For example, in some embodiments, the shapes of the first opening **102A** and the second opening **102B** may be circle (refer to FIG. 3A), square (refer to FIG. 3B), rectangle (refer to FIG. 3C) or the combination thereof (refer to FIG. 3D), etc. In addition, in some embodiments, the tube wall **102H** of the primary waveguide tube **102** may have multiple auxiliary openings **102C**. The opening positions, number, sizes and shapes of the auxiliary openings **102C** may be adjusted according to the functional and the process requirements. For example, in the present embodiment, multiple auxiliary openings are disposed at the lateral sides of the first portion **102F** or the lateral sides of the second portion **102G**.

[0045] With this design, it may be convenience to adjust the number and arrangements of the microwave absorber **200**. The number, shapes and the arrangements of the microwave absorber **200** may be adjusted according to the functional and the process requirements. For example, in some embodiments, multiple microwave absorbers **200** may be disposed integrally or separately in the primary waveguide tube **102** to form a heating chamber at a single temperature or multiple heating chambers at different temperature. For example, in some embodiments, multiple microwave absorbers **200** may be disposed in the primary waveguide tube **102** through the auxiliary openings **102C** and increase the heat efficiency to the thread-type object **400** according to the functional and the process requirements. In addition, microwave absorbers **200** may be circle, square, rectangle and ellipse or any shapes that the thread-type object **400** may pass through.

[0046] FIG. 4 is a stereoscopic schematic view of the microwave heat processing apparatus installed on a driving device **500**, which uses the arrangements of the microwave absorber to achieve the heat processing in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. Please refer to the FIG. 4. The driving device **500** includes a guide-line frame **500A**, a front tension machine **500B**, a cool water device **500C**, a back tension machine **500D**, a winding machine **500E** and a control platform **500F**.

[0047] As shown in FIG. 4, the microwave heat processing apparatus **100** is placed on the stand **402**, and the thread-type object **400** passes the microwave heat processing apparatus **100** at a uniform speed by the guide-line frame **500A**, the front tension machine **500B**, the back tension machine **500D**, and the winding machine **500E**. The thread-type object **400** may be heated in the microwave heat processing apparatus **100** at a uniform speed by the driving device **500**. During the heat process, the moving speed may be controlled by the control platform **500F** according to the process requirements. In addition, the thread-type object **400** may be fibers, silks, man-made fibers or man-made silks that the thread-type object **400** may pass through. It should be noticed that these examples should not limit the scope of the embodiment.

[0048] According to some embodiments of the present disclosure, a microwave heat processing apparatus is provided. A particular arrangement structure of the microwave absorber is disposed in the microwave heat processing apparatus. The arrangement structure of the microwave absorber has a high temperature stability and extraordinary thermal conductivity. The thread-type object may be heated by absorbing the traveling wave produced by a microwave source and further heated by the microwave absorber. Thus, the present disclosure may achieve a uniform heating during the microwave-heat processing thereby accomplishing a high efficiency, stable and uniform heat processing.

[0049] Although several embodiments of the disclosure are described above, it is not intended to limit this disclosure. Those skilled in the art may use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein without difficulty. Those skilled in the

art should also realize that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A microwave heat processing apparatus, comprising: a microwave chamber configured to heat a thread-type object, comprising; a primary waveguide tube configured to accommodate the thread-type object, wherein a tube wall of the primary waveguide tube has an auxiliary opening, and a center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube does not pass through the auxiliary opening; and a microwave absorber in the primary waveguide tube; and a microwave source connected to the primary waveguide tube.
2. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein the primary waveguide tube further includes a first opening and a second opening and the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube passes through the first opening and the second opening.
3. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 2, wherein a plane where the auxiliary opening is located intersects a plane where the first opening is located.
4. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein the tube wall of the primary waveguide tube further has a cooling opening, and a size of the auxiliary opening is greater than a size of the cooling opening.
5. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 4, wherein the primary waveguide tube has a first portion and a second portion, and the first portion of the primary waveguide tube is closer to the microwave source than the second portion of the primary waveguide tube, and the cooling opening is disposed at the first portion of the primary waveguide tube.
6. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein a plurality of auxiliary openings are symmetrically disposed with respect to the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube.
7. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein an extending direction of the auxiliary openings is parallel with the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube.
8. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, further comprising: a microwave baffle covering the auxiliary openings.
9. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein the microwave chamber further comprises an auxiliary waveguide tube connected between the primary waveguide tube and the microwave source, wherein the microwave source deviates from the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube.
10. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 9, wherein the auxiliary waveguide tube has a discharge opening, and the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube passes through the discharge opening.
11. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein a size of the auxiliary opening is greater than a size of the microwave absorber.
12. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein a length of the auxiliary opening is greater than a length of the microwave absorber.
13. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 1, wherein the microwave absorber forms a heating chamber inside the primary waveguide tube.
14. The microwave heat processing apparatus of claim 13, wherein the center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube passes through the heating chamber.
15. A microwave heat processing apparatus, comprising: a microwave chamber configured to heat a thread-type object, comprising; a primary waveguide tube configured to accommodate the thread-type object; a first auxiliary opening on a first tube wall of the primary waveguide tube; a second auxiliary opening on a second tube wall of the primary waveguide tube opposite to the first tube wall, wherein a center extending direction of the primary waveguide tube does not pass through the

first and second auxiliary openings; and a microwave absorber in the primary waveguide tube; and a microwave source connected to the primary waveguide tube.
